CURRICULUM VITAE

Simran Chopra, PhD

Mixed-Methods UX Researcher · Products & Services

simchopra@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/simranchopra · simranchopra.com · UK, Global Talent Visa holder

9+ years of applied research
6+ launched products
12+ user-centred innovations
20+ peer-reviewed publications

SUMMARY

User researcher with a PhD in Human-Computer Interaction and 9+ years leading end-to-end research in complex, multidisciplinary environments. I've practised across the full range of qualitative and quantitative methods, with particular expertise in ethical, trauma-informed research with vulnerable or marginalised participants. I'm an experienced mentor and builder of research capability, and I translate complex findings into clear, actionable insight for delivery teams, senior stakeholders and policy audiences.

EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Research Associate · MoSaIC: More-than-Human Smart Cities

2024–present
City St George's, University of London & University of the Arts London · DEFRA, Arup, UKRI

- Establishing a living-lab field site that contributes project-wide methods and policy engagement.
- Leading research into service design and policy decisions for stakeholders across government, industry and third-sector organisations.

Postdoctoral Research Associate · Peoplehood, Blockchain for Social Good

2022–2024
University of Edinburgh, Design Informatics · Blackwood Group, Timebanking UK

- Led co-design research with marginalised communities facing social isolation in several Scottish cities.
- Designed and used inclusive methods to surface needs and barriers that standard approaches would have missed.
- Developed Exchangeopoly, a board game for exploring collective decision-making and value exchange, used as a research tool to generate evidence about governance and community participation.
- Managed research operations and delivery, and supervised junior designers and PhD students.

Co-Founder · CookUp Inc. · 0-to-1 product 2020–2023
Pear2Pear

- Co-founded, and ran research for, a platform turning indie chefs into micro-entrepreneurs, taking the product to Beta.
- Worked with design, management and engineering to translate business strategy into a working consumer experience.
- Designed end-to-end research infrastructure that delivered directional insight, iterating features through unmoderated feedback loops.

Research Assistant · Co-creating Visions for a Racially Equal University

2021–2022
Northumbria University · CoCreate, Pro:NE, Race Equality Charter

- Led an ethically sensitive, trauma-informed qualitative study with BAME participants navigating discrimination, harassment and institutional failure.
- Designed and applied protocols for participant safety, consent and data handling, and produced recommendations co-created with participants to inform equity policy.

EDUCATION

PhD, Computer & Information Sciences (HCI)
Northumbria University · 2017–2023
Thesis: Designing for Participatory Visioning: HCI for Reconciling Sustainability Visions with Everyday Practice

M.Des, New Media Design
National Institute of Design, India · 2010–2013

BA (Hons) Communication Design
Nottingham Trent University · 2003–2007

RESEARCH METHODS

Qualitative

Co-design sessions · Participatory workshops · Contextual inquiry · Ethnographic field studies · In-depth interviews · Focus groups · Diary studies · Personas · Critical user journeys · Usability testing

Quantitative

Surveys · Questionnaires · A/B testing · Intercept surveys · Unmoderated studies · Task analysis · Mixed-methods evaluation

Research ops

Participant recruitment · Screeners · Agency & stakeholder management · GDPR · WCAG 2.2

FUNCTIONAL EXPERTISE

Agile research · Ethical & trauma-informed methods · HCI · ICT4D · CSCW · Mobile & ubiquitous computing · Voice interfaces & AI agents · Multimodal interfaces · Healthcare · User-centred design

AWARDS

Named researcher, UKRI grant (£1.6M) · 2024–27

Northumbria RDF Studentship · 2017–22

Winner, Banksia Ignite SDG Carpooling Service Design Challenge · 2019

TEI Best Paper Presentation · 2018

Samsung Excellence Award, Outstanding Project of the Year (Samsung Z1) · 2015

Senior UX Researcher · AI Systems, Cross-cultural UX, Tizen OS 2014–2017
Samsung R&D Institute, Bangalore · NXT Gen Lab

- Ran foundational, evaluative and iterative research in an agile environment for the Samsung Z1 and Tizen OS, released in India, Bangladesh and Sri Lanka (Outstanding Project of the Year, 2015).
- Defined and led UX research across Samsung Health, Wearables, Human-AI Trust, Voice Assistants and Autonomous Agents.
- Translated research into design decisions within sprint cycles for Bixby's integration into Samsung phones. Helped define Samsung Fold positioning through market research, intercept surveys, interviews and diary studies.
- Presented findings to senior leadership and cross-functional stakeholders in India, Korea and the US.

Design Research Consultant · Inito Fertility Monitor 2014–2017
Samplytics, for Inito Health Inc.

- Scoped and ran in-home usability research for a health diagnostics device, from ideation to implementation.
- Delivered redesign recommendations for the production launch. The redesigned onboarding flows reached 89% task completion.

Design Researcher & Project Manager · Records for Life 2013–2014
Centre for Knowledge Societies, for the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation · fieldwork in Kenya, India, Indonesia

- Designed and managed cross-country field research, leading a multidisciplinary team of 7+ designers, engineers and researchers.
- Ran research operations end to end: agency briefing, local team management, screener development and recruitment in three countries.
- Turned findings on digital health service uptake into service-design recommendations for international policymakers, using multimedia stories and design toolkits.

AHRC Research Grant, A Punjabi Palimpsest · 2013

British Council Creative Economy Fellowship · 2013

Stanford India Biodesign Fellowship, top 15 · 2013

USID India silver, UX design · 2012

Adobe India Design Labs, creative excellence · 2011

SERVICE

Associate Chair, ACM DIS · 2024–26

Reviewer: CHI, CSCW, DIS, PDC, TEI

Member, ACM and SIGCHI

Advisory Board Director, Greening Wingrove CIC · 2023–25

VOLUNTEERING

Greening Wingrove CIC · Ouseburn Farm Charity · Star & Shadow Community Cinema & Community Kitchen

PUBLICATIONS

20+ peer-reviewed papers. Full list on Google Scholar (scholar.google.com, Simran Chopra).